



My journey to applying for a PhD in Information Science at Cornell began with a simple, straightforward, and ambitious dream: Combining Art and Science to build meaningful and profound technological things in state-of-the-art research thought and methodology. As a student and practitioner, spanning Visual Art to Computer Science and User Experience Design to Information Systems Development, I witnessed firsthand my toils, uneasiness, and accomplishments, and I thoroughly observed the significant advancements in the Chinese Internet Applications and Software Engineering fields. During 20 years of leading teams in Frontend Design, Software Development, and Information Architecture at 51job, Zhaopin, and China UnionPay, building platforms for over 100 million users. There, I observed, globally and around the Chinese Internet Tech-World, some succeed, but most fail because of the lack of User Factors, Requirements Analysis, and Information Science Thoughtfulness, particularly the HCI creativity and rigorousness. And most importantly, I saw my eagerness to gain more scholarly work opportunities for not to waste my research potential and my talents in HCI and Information Science.

Therefore, at the age of 45, I left the industry and started my 2nd learning journey to study abroad in the US at the Stevens Institute of Technology. I earned an MS in Software Engineering (2023, 3.73 GPA) and am pursuing a second degree in Computer Science (expected 2026). Studied at Stevens, and after that, in the past two years, worked on research and teaching at multiple academic places, like Raffles Design Institute and Donghua or Jiaotong AGI lab; I accelerated my comprehension in contemporary HCI and leveraging AI on Art-Tech-intersectional Systems Architecture, and cumulated ample growth in Information Science examinations. I led and single-handedly developed three recent research works: an AI-assisted learning and grading platform, a Co-pilot Intelligent Driving scenario research thesis, and an AI-augmented Markup-scripting Language Design for Zero-code development. These projects do align with my research interests and paths, and demonstrate resilience in my knack for spotting practical Information Science solutions across domains. And my other works, a framework IDM (Interactive Dialogue Mode) that enhances AI explainability, and an evolved HCI scenario research for building the Next-Gen Smart City technology (Environmental Human Behavior-driven Social Computing), certainly manifested that I have a high research potential in creativity and diversity on realistic examination.

Cornell's Information Science PhD program, especially the NYC Cornell Tech, shall be the most and best fit for me based on my Art-Science interdisciplinary majored background, previous industrial experience in User Factors Analysis-driven Software Engineering, and ample understanding of modern HCI and Domain-crossed Systems architecture designs. Significantly, Cornell Tech, as a rare combination of New York City's creative ecosystem, cross-disciplinary labs, and explicit priority on equitable socio-technical systems, is the best place where my particular mix of skills can be put to full use, such as mentoring students who started in art rather than code; bring production-tested deployment experience that most 25-year-olds simply do not have; and help labs move faster from working prototypes to population-scale impact - exactly the kind of translation from industry to scholarship. As an older international learner who left a secure career to build a technical base almost to zero, I have experienced firsthand the challenges associated with having an unconventional schedule. It is that acquired outlook, along with that creative breadth which it has brought forth, that I am offering to Cornell and her community of inclusion and belonging.